Gravity SOP Foundry

Windows Edition - Beta

COMPREHENSIVE USER MANUAL - BLACK & WHITE PRINT EDITION

A manager workspace for building, revising, publishing, teaching, printing, and maintaining restaurant SOPs, recipes, posters, employee training records, and related operating knowledge.

Release: Public Beta	**Platform:** Windows x64
Distribution: Easy-install ZIP	**Edition:** Black & White

This edition is optimized for black-and-white printing and never relies on color alone to explain a procedure.

Important

Keep program data and backups under restaurant control. Verify this beta on the restaurant's own Windows hardware before broad operational reliance.

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Quick Start

Install and verify the program before entering production data.

Easy-install sequence

1	Download the Windows Beta ZIP from Thomas Monroe Books.
2	Right-click the ZIP and choose Extract All. Do not run the program from inside the ZIP.
3	Open the extracted folder and double-click the clearly named INSTALL GRAVITY ... command file.
4	Allow Windows to finish the per-user installation. Administrator rights normally are not required.
5	Launch the program from the Desktop or Start Menu shortcut created by the installer.
6	Complete the first-run profile/setup and create a backup after initial configuration.

First-run verification checklist

- Program launches from the Start Menu/Desktop shortcut.
- Restaurant/location profile is correct.
- A small test record can be saved and reopened.
- Print or PDF output works on the intended device.
- A backup can be created and is stored outside the live data folder.
- Any employee/public link or QR feature is tested from a second device where applicable.

Program Map

The map below uses the names of controls in the current packaged Windows beta.

Build

- Build Room
- Build SOPs
- SOP Editor
- Revision History

Content

- Food Recipes
- Bar Drink Recipes
- Poster Library & Studio

Employees

- Employee Library
- Employee Mobile App
- Training Records
- Employee Messages

Controls

- Restaurant Branding & Backups
- Room PIN Settings
- Backup & Setup

Insight

- Gravity Signals
- Ask Gravity
- Help & User Guide

Core operating flow

1	Choose a station or procedure
2	Start from a master SOP or create a new SOP
3	Edit restaurant-specific steps, standards, and responsibilities
4	Review and save the revision
5	Decide whether the revision requires re-teaching
6	Publish the approved SOP
7	Employees read, train, quiz, and acknowledge
8	Review training records, questions, and manager-side signals

Built-in help, examples, and glossary

The Windows Beta includes in-program guidance so a manager does not have to guess what an unfamiliar field, control, or term means. Use the guidance before relying on memory or making assumptions.

- Hover help: pause over supported fields and buttons for a short explanation of what the control does or what belongs in the field.
- Examples: fields that can be confusing include sample formats or entries where practical, such as times, units, locations, roles, or notes.
- Glossary: use the in-program manager glossary for terms such as Draft, Approved, Published, revision, effective date, training requirement, knowledge check, hands-on sign-off, QR code, Gravity Signals, and backup.
- If the on-screen guidance and this manual ever appear to disagree, stop and verify the current program behavior before using the result operationally.

1. Installation and first launch

Install the program

Use the easy-install ZIP. Extract it first, then run INSTALL GRAVITY SOP FOUNDRY.cmd. The installer places the application in the current Windows user profile, creates shortcuts, and registers an uninstall entry.

First manager actions

Open the Build Room, review restaurant branding, change both default room PINs from 0000, confirm the employee experience, and create the first backup before entering substantial custom content.

Beta release note

This is a public beta. The packaged application has been structurally checked, but managers should verify launch, printing/PDF, QR access, and employee mobile behavior on their own Windows hardware before broad staff rollout.

2. How Foundry is organized

Build Room

The manager side is the control center. It provides access to SOP building, recipes, posters, backup/setup, branding, manager-only signals, employee messages, training records, and Ask Gravity.

Employee side

The Employee Library is a read-focused experience for published SOPs, recipes, training, quizzes, acknowledgments, posters, and questions. Managers can open the employee view from Windows for support and verification.

Station organization

SOPs are organized by workstation/station. Employees may browse published material across stations so cross-training is not artificially blocked.

3. Build SOPs and edit procedures

Start from the procedure list

Open Build SOPs and select a procedure. Use the list to find the right master or restaurant-specific SOP before editing.

Use the larger editor workspace

The SOP Editor provides the main writing area. Keep the procedure actionable: purpose, responsibility, preparation, steps, standards, verification, safety, and corrective action where appropriate.

Avoid duplicate SOPs

Before creating a new SOP, search the existing masters and restaurant library. Revise or adapt the correct source whenever possible so employees do not receive competing instructions.

4. Revision control and publishing

Preserve history

When a published SOP changes, preserve the prior revision. Revision History should remain the record of what changed and when.

Re-teach decision

The person revising the SOP decides whether the change requires re-teaching. Do not let the assistant make that governance decision automatically.

Publish deliberately

Draft, review, and approve before publishing. After publication, verify the employee copy and any QR-linked access to ensure the correct revision is visible.

5. Employee Library, mobile access, and QR

Manager verification

Use the Windows Employee Library to see what staff see before distributing access.

Hosted access

Where hosted employee access is enabled, fresh QR codes should point employees to the current hosted route. Regenerate old codes when a route/version change requires it.

Cross-station learning

Assigned station content should be easy to find first, but published SOPs across other stations remain available for development and cross-training.

6. Training, quizzes, acknowledgments, and records

Training sequence

A typical sequence is Read SOP -> Train -> Quiz/Test -> Acknowledge -> Manager review of training records.

Use records as evidence

Training Records should show what was assigned/completed and support follow-up when a revision requires re-teaching.

Keep employee experience simple

Employees should not need manager controls to learn. Keep editing, publishing, PINs, backups, and manager analytics separated from staff use.

7. Food recipes and bar drink recipes

Maintain recipes as operational standards

Recipes should be specific enough to reproduce the product: ingredients, quantity/unit, method, yield/portion, presentation, holding/storage, and revision notes as needed.

Import existing material

Use recipe import functions for existing source material when practical. Review imported content rather than assuming formatting equals accuracy.

Separate editions correctly

Commercial/customer builds must remain generic and customer-brandable. River-specific recipes or branding do not belong in the customer Windows edition.

8. Posters

Build station-ready references

Poster Library & Studio supports visual station references that complement, rather than replace, the controlling SOP.

Link poster and SOP

Where useful, connect posters to their underlying SOP so an employee can move from a quick visual reminder to the full procedure.

Review after revisions

When a source SOP changes, check related posters for stale instructions and update them where necessary.

9. Branding, backup, and restore

Restaurant branding

Use Restaurant Branding & Backups to add customer identity where supported. Gravity branding remains part of the product; the customer logo personalizes restaurant-facing output.

Backup routinely

Back up before large imports, structural changes, major SOP revisions, or program updates. Keep more than one dated backup outside the application data folder.

Test restore intentionally

A backup is useful only if it can be restored. Periodically test restore on a safe copy or controlled environment rather than discovering a problem during an emergency.

10. Gravity Signals, employee messages, and Ask Gravity

Signals are manager-side indicators

Gravity Signals summarizes patterns that may deserve attention, such as repeated SOP/poster views, training trouble, revision revisit spikes, unanswered searches, or station attention. Treat indicators as prompts to investigate, not automatic judgments.

Employee messages

Questions or error reports from the employee side should flow to the manager workspace for review and correction.

Ask Gravity

Use Ask Gravity to explain the Foundry, help locate procedures, or reason through operational questions. The controlling published SOP remains the operating standard.

11. Printing, binder creation, and export

Print employee-ready material

Preview before printing. Verify logo, page breaks, procedure text, revision information, and QR codes on the actual printer or PDF destination used by the restaurant.

SOP binder

Use binder printing to produce a controlled physical reference when the restaurant requires paper access. Printed copies should be reviewed after significant revisions so old pages do not remain in circulation.

Export/backup distinction

An export is for using or moving selected content; a backup is for restoring the workspace. Do not treat them as interchangeable.

12. Manager security

Change default PINs

The initial room PINs are 0000. Change both before staff access.

Protect manager-only areas

Do not share manager PINs casually. Manager-only functions include editing, publishing, backups, settings, and Gravity Signals.

Use least access necessary

Employees should use the Employee Library/mobile experience for routine learning rather than the Build Room.

13. Recommended operating cadence

Each revision

Review -> approve -> decide re-teach -> publish -> verify employee view -> update poster/QR if needed.

Weekly

Review employee questions, training records, signal patterns, stale drafts, and outstanding revisions.

Monthly

Create a dated backup, review restaurant branding/contact details, test a representative QR, and spot-check printed materials against current revisions.

14. Troubleshooting

Program does not open

Confirm the ZIP was extracted before installation. Try the Start Menu shortcut. If Windows blocks an unsigned beta build, review the Windows security prompt rather than disabling security protections.

Employee QR does not open current material

Regenerate the QR when the hosted route has changed, then test it from a phone outside the manager PC.

Print preview looks wrong

Confirm the correct SOP/recipe is selected, check scaling and destination printer/PDF settings, and verify that the customer logo is a supported image.

Data appears missing after update

Do not overwrite or delete the data folder. Restore only from a known-good backup after confirming the program is pointing to the expected user data location.

Manager Rollout Checklist

- Install from the extracted easy-install ZIP and confirm the shortcut launches the correct program.
- Enter restaurant-specific setup and save a test record.
- Verify printing/PDF output and any QR/public link behavior used by the restaurant.
- Create and retain a dated backup before live rollout.
- Train the manager who owns the process, not just the person who installs the software.
- Run one controlled live cycle before depending on the program for the entire restaurant.
- Document any beta issue with the screen, action, expected result, and actual result.

Release posture

The software is distributed as a Windows Beta. Use it operationally with normal management controls, backups, verification, and a fallback method until the restaurant has completed its own successful live cycle. The release also includes field-level hover help, examples where needed, and an in-program glossary/help path.